

NICHOLAS SWEENEY

University of Manchester, United Kingdom

[Email](#) ◇ [Website](#)

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

Sir Terry Leahy Fellow of Urban and Regional Economics

2025 –

Three-year appointment at the Alliance Manchester Business School, University of Manchester

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

Sweeney, N. (2026) ‘Spatial Variation in Mobility Across England: Evidence from 21 Million Geo-coded Credit-Card Flows’. *Spatial Economic Analysis*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. (2026) ‘Devolution and Economic Growth in English City Regions’. *Urban Studies*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. (2026) ‘Challenging the S of Mayoral Strategic Authorities: Standardisation Over Strategy?’. *The Political Quarterly*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. (2025) ‘Devolution, Health and Health Inequalities in Greater Manchester’. *Social Science & Medicine*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. (2025) ‘Devolution and Democratic Engagement in England’. *Political Geography*. [DOI](#).

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

Ioramashvili, C. & Sweeney, N. (2026) *Ticket to Impact: Estimating the impact of transport connectivity on collaborative research projects*. Oxford, UK: Innovation and Research Caucus. [Report](#).

EDUCATION

Land Economy, PhD, St Catharine’s College, University of Cambridge

2022 – 2026

Started 1 October 2022; submitted 26 September 2025; graduated 22 May 2026

- **Thesis & Funding:** ‘Devolution and Space in England: Empirical Essays on Economic Growth, Democratic Engagement and Health’; fully funded by the ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership; [DOI](#).

Land Economy by Research, MPhil, Darwin College, University of Cambridge

2021 – 2022

Distinction (75%)

- **Awards & Achievements:** £12,000 Cambridge Trust (Grace Goh Studentship); 87% in Research Methods

Land Economy, BA, Jesus College, University of Cambridge

2018 – 2021

Double First-class (73.4%)

- **Awards & Achievements:** Most marks in cohort across all three years; prizes for best final-year dissertation (82%), best overall second-year performance (71.6%), best overall (71%) and Economics, first-year performance

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Sir Terry Leahy Fellow of Urban and Regional Economics

2025 –

- Research spanning multiple themes surrounding subnational inequalities and growth, with a particular focus on modelling innovation, mobility and political patterns of discontent using big data
- Winner of Best Presentation at Regional Science Association International (British and Irish Section) Early Career Colloquium 2026
- Data Lead on agreements with TravelTime API, The Elections Centre, Rail Data Marketplace

University of Cambridge Interviewer

2022 – *Trinity Hall* & 2024 – *Sidney Sussex*

- Entrusted to be one of four interviewers for candidates for undergraduate Land Economy applications
- Consulted on final selection of candidates, justifying my reasoning based on objective criteria

University of Cambridge Supervisor

Department of Land Economy

Autumn 2022
Cambridge, UK

- Supervised 60 second year undergraduates on ‘Paper 11: Land and Urban Economics’, marking essays, giving feedback and clarifying technical and theoretical problems in small group formats
- Covered the topics of agglomeration, reasons for co-location of highly skilled couples, retail accessibility as a determinant of place attractiveness and whether big cities were ‘bad places to live’

OTHER ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

– **Dissemination invitations** (theme, date; earliest first): University of Cambridge (innovation geography, Dec 2025); The Productivity Institute (innovation geography, Jan 2026); London School of Economics (innovation geography, Feb 2026); Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government (devolution, Feb 2026); HM Treasury (devolution, Mar 2026); RSAI-BIS Conference Belfast (big data mobility, invited early career researcher, May 2026)

– **Journal referee:** Regional Studies

– **Advisory positions:** Scientific Advisory Board member for the Biologics Regional Innovation and Technology Ecosystem ([BRITE](#)) UKRI project

POLICY EXPERIENCE

Data Science Intern

September 2023 – March 2024

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development

Paris, France

- Recruited to employ Natural Language Processing techniques to explore the potential for big data (full text job listings) to illustrate how the digital and green (‘twin’) transition is impacting labour markets
- During my internship, I also focused on analysing sector-specific datasets, particularly in mining, using R and Python to present findings for the LESI Division

Researcher

- **MillNET** [i](#) Summer 2021 – *Virtual*
Analysed household income and diet panel data in The Gambia and Ethiopia during COVID-19. [Project](#).
- **ASEAN Development Outlook Report** Summer 2020 – *Virtual*
Contributed notes and proofreading on identity, environment, livelihoods, welfare and health. [DOI](#).

SKILLS

Data access	Office of National Statistics Accredited Researcher (no. 36517, exp. Nov. 2026)
Software	Proficient in Python , R , LaTeX , STATA , intermediate in QGIS
Communication	Intermediate French language

OTHER

Societies and interests	University of Manchester Humanities Fellows Committee, Hawks’ Club President & Committee, Cambridge University Association Football Club Secretary
Date of birth	19 July 2000

Last updated: August 21, 2026